GG-P-171C
January 28, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GG-P-171B
July 2, 1957

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PENCIL, SKIN MARKING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Services, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers skin-marking pencils suitable for use in surgical procedures such as outlining incision and anesthetic areas.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Pencils shall be of the following types and classes as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Single color
  Class A - Wood casing
  Class B - Paper casing

Type II - Two-color combination
  Class A - Wood casing
  Class B - Paper casing

1.2.2 Colors. Pencils and marking mediums shall be of the color or colors specified (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

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Federal Specifications

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Shipping, Foberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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LAWS AND REGULATIONS

21 CFR 1 - Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Marking medium.

3.1.1.1 Standard of purity. The marking media shall be composed of ingredients which shall be non-toxic and non-irritating to human skin, and shall meet the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act as applicable to externally applied cosmetics.

3.1.1.2 Composition. Each marking medium shall be a mixture of extender, wax and pigments. The marking medium shall be of such consistency that, as part of a pencil, it can be sharpened without crumbling.

3.1.2 Casings.

3.1.2.1 Wood. Wood casings, when specified (see 1.2.1, 3.3.1 and 6.1), shall be made from well-seasoned, straight-grained red or incense cedar. The wood shall be suitable for shaving the end of pencil (for repointing) with a knife.

3.1.2.2 Paper. Paper casings, when specified (see 1.2.1, 3.3.2 and 6.1), shall be made from wood paper suitable for spiral winding about a marking medium.

3.1.3 Point protector. The point protector shall be made from material suitable for protecting a pencil point from breakage when the pencil is not being used.

3.2 Design.

3.2.1 Type I pencils.

3.2.1.1 Assembled pencil. Type I pencils shall be supplied with a single color marking medium. The marking medium for the pencil shall be supplied in one piece. The pencil shall be supplied unsharpened or having one end sharpened (pointed). A sharpened, blunt-pointed pencil shall be acceptable. If one end is sharpened, that end shall be capped when a point protector is supplied (see 3.2.1.5).

3.2.1.2 Marking medium color. The marking medium color shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 1.2.2 and 6.1).

3.2.1.3 Dimensions. The overall length of the type I pencil shall be not less than 6-3/4 inches. The marking medium for the pencil shall be essentially circular in cross section with a minimum diameter of 1/8-inch.

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3.2.1.4 Casing. The casing construction shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 3.3 and 6.1).

3.2.1.5 Point protector. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), one end of the type I pencil shall be capped with a point protector (see 3.1.3).

3.2.2 Type II pencils.

3.2.2.1 Assembled pencil. Type II pencils shall consist of two marking media of different colors (see 3.2.2.2), positioned to form a double-ended pencil in accordance with either of the following:

a. The two marking media are enclosed in a single casing to form a two-color combination pencil.

b. Each marking medium is enclosed in a separate casing; the casings are positioned end to end to form a two-color combination pencil. The two casings are joined with a plug of suitable material and then permanently secured together by tube of suitable material which covers the junction of the two casings.

The type II pencil shall be supplied with both ends sharpened (pointed) or unsharpened. Each marking medium shall be supplied in one piece. Sharpened pencils that are blunt-pointed shall be acceptable.

3.2.2.2 Marking medium colors. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the marking medium colors shall be red and blue.

3.2.2.3 Dimensions. The usable length of each marking medium for the type II pencil shall be not less than 2-1/4 inches. When the Type II pencil consists of two casings (see 3.2.2.1), the length of the joining tube shall be not less than 3/4-inch. Each marking medium shall be essentially circular in cross section with a minimum diameter of 1/8-inch.

3.2.2.4 Casing. The casing construction shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 1.2.1, 3.3 and 6.1).

3.2.2.5 Point protector. Unless otherwise specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.1), both ends of the type II pencil shall be capped with point protectors (see 3.1.3).

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Class A (wood casings).

3.3.1.1 Assembled pencil. Wood casings, when specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.1),

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shall enclose the marking medium in a neat, secure manner. Both halves of the wood casing shall be of uniform structure and shall be securely glued together throughout the entire length of the pencil.

3.3.1.2 Finish. The color finish on each casing shall indicate the color of the enclosed marking medium.

3.3.2 Class B (paper casing).

3.3.2.1 Assembled pencil. Paper casing, when specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.1), shall be a perforated paper wrapper in spiral form. The paper casing shall be tightly rolled about a marking medium and hold it firmly in place. Each perforated strip shall be arranged so that it may be readily removed to expose the marking medium point.

3.3.2.2 Cutting thread. A cutting thread shall be supplied with the spiral winding to cut the paper stripping so that it can be removed in order to expose the marking medium point.

3.3.2.3 Finish. The color finish on each casing shall indicate the color of the enclosed marking medium.

3.4 Marking quality characteristics. Each marking medium shall mark distinctly on human skin, without smearing, through fuel oil, grease, salt water or perspiration. The marking on skin shall remain a minimum of 24 hours (see 3.7). When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the applied marking shall be legible.

3.5 Product markings. Each pencil shall be clearly marked to include the following:

a. The manufacturer's or contractor's name or trademark.
b. The applicable commercial part number(s) of the pencil.
c. "SKIN MARKING PENCIL".

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The pencils shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. Each marking medium shall have a uniformly distributed single color throughout its length. The marking medium shall be essentially centered through the length of the pencil. The pencils shall be free of warping, distortion or breaks . The pencils shall be free of dirt and foreign matter.

3.7 Instruction sheet. Each pencil shall be supplied with an instruction sheet that includes the following as a minimum:

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"SKIN MARKING PENCIL

"Effective in the presence of fuel oil, grease, sea water, or perspiration. This skin pencil will maintain legibility when used through fuel oil, tar, etc. If left for 60 seconds without smearing, marking will remain a minimum of 24 hours."

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the marking medium, verifying that the ingredients conform to 3.1.1.1, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract or purchase order number, and the name of the manufacturer of supplier.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with table I and MIL-STD-105. The unit of product for examination shall be an individual pencil.

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TABLE I. Sampling for examination

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Minor defects	II	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level
Marking quality	3.4	4.4.1	*

* A minimum of two pencils shall be tested for each lot of marking medium. Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The pencil shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table III. Examination shall not be restricted to the possible defects listed in the table.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major:	
101	Marking medium not securely held within casing.
102	Marking medium not free of imbedded foreign material.
103	Pencil not free of warping or distortion.
104	Pencil not free of breaks.
105	Color of casing of pencil not the color of marking medium.
106	Point protector, when required, not supplied or not capable of being properly secured to end of pencil.
107	Two casings, if supplied for type II pencils, not adequately secured together at the junction.
Minor:	
201	Identification marking on pencil not complete, legible and permanent.
202	Color finish on casing of pencil not free of excessive scratches or chipping.
203	Exposed surfaces of pencil not free of removable dirt or foreign matter.

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4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The pencils shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within specified limits shall be classified as a defect.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Marking quality. The test shall be conducted at room temperature. The pencil marking medium shall be used to make marks on human skin through fuel oil, grease, salt water and perspiration. Each mark shall be left on the skin for 60 seconds without smearing. After an interval of 5 minutes, the fuel oil, grease, salt water and perspiration stains, through which the markings were made, shall be carefully cleansed from the skin with soap and water.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE IV. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each pencil shall be packaged in a paper carton or envelope of appropriate size. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Forty eight pencils shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for s pment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Five hundred and seventy six units shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproofed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Five hundred and seventy six units shall be packed in a box designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 2, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or Fed. Std. No. 123 as specified.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable type and class for each pencil (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable marking medium color for type I pencil (see 1.2.2. and 3.2.1.2).
d. Indication when required marking medium colors for type II pencil are not red and blue (see 1.2.2 and 3.2.2.2).
e. When point protector is not required (see 3.2.1.5 or 3.2.2.5).
f. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing
g. (see 5.1 and 5.2).
g. Marking document required (see 5.3).

6.2 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the type normally procured to meet Federal requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DSA-DM

Project No. 6515-1923

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
VA-DMS
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GG-P-171C - Pencil, Skin Marking

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

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1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

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